STAFF HANDBOOK

Downtown Barbers AS · Org. no. 921 204 132 · Osterhaus' gate 10, 0183 Oslo

Version 1.0 · effective from 1 November 2026

Contents

1. Purpose and scope
2. Organisation and contacts
3. The employment relationship
4. Working hours and attendance
5. Opening and closing routines
6. Pay and remuneration
7. Till and payment
8. Holidays, absence and illness
9. Customer service
10. Dress, appearance and mobile phones
11. Smoking, snus and short breaks
12. Privacy, confidentiality and social media
13. Hygiene and infection control
14. Health, safety and environment (HSE)
15. Fire, first aid, violence and threats
16. Deviations, whistleblowing and harassment
17. Alcohol and drugs
18. Training of new employees
19. Changes

1. Purpose and scope

This Staff Handbook sets out the routines and rules of Downtown Barbers AS (the Employer) for work in the salon. It applies to all employees, regardless of position percentage.

The Handbook supplements the employment contract and applicable legislation, including the Working Environment Act and the Annual Holidays Act. In the event of conflict, the law and the employment contract take precedence over the Handbook.

The Employee shall be familiar with the Handbook and keep up to date with any changes, cf. clause 13 of the employment contract. The Handbook is signed upon employment. The Norwegian version is the governing text.

2. Organisation and contacts

Role	Responsibility
Owner – Dawit Solomon Mengistu	Overall responsibility for the business and for health and safety (HSE).
General manager	Rota, holidays and absence, till, training and staff follow-up.
Person in charge on shift	The person designated in the rota when the general manager is not present.
HSE contact – Kochari	Receives input from employees on the working environment and takes part in the risk assessment.
Project manager / IT – Kidus	Booking and till system, My page and access rights.
Accountant	Payroll and accounts. Enquiries are made via the general manager.

The Employer can be contacted at **jobb@downtownbarbers.no** or **+47 922 77 049**. If the general manager is unavailable, contact the owner.

Emergency numbers: fire 110 · police 112 · ambulance 113 · out-of-hours medical service 116 117 · Poison Information 22 59 13 00.

3. The employment relationship

- All employees have a written employment contract before starting work.
- Trial period, notice periods, salary and other terms follow from the employment contract. Notice of termination shall be given in writing.
- An appraisal interview is held at least once a year.
- Secondary employment, including cutting hair on one's own account or for others, requires the written consent of the general manager. The salon's customers may not be transferred to such work, cf. the customer clause in the employment contract.
- Changes of address, telephone number, bank account and next of kin shall be reported to the general manager without delay.
- Employment contract, payslips and other personal documents are available under «My documents» in the staff portal.

4. Working hours and attendance

The salon is open Monday–Saturday 10:00–20:00. Working hours follow the rota, which is published in the staff portal.

Attendance

- The Employee shall be present no later than 10 minutes before the shift starts, changed and ready at the chair when the shift begins.
- Delays shall be reported to the general manager by telephone before the shift starts, stating the expected time of arrival. A text message alone is not sufficient.
- Repeated lateness is followed up with a meeting and may have consequences for the employment relationship.

Clocking in and out

- Employees clock in and out on the till at every shift. Registered time forms the basis for pay.
- A missed clock-in or clock-out shall be reported to the general manager the same day.
- Clocking in or out on behalf of others is not permitted.

Breaks and shift swaps

- The Employee has a 30-minute break per working day. The break is taken outside bookings and is not split up unless agreed.
- Shift swaps and transfer of customers are agreed directly with a colleague. The Employee ensures that the swap is reflected in the rota and the bookings.

5. Opening and closing routines

The person opening ensures that the salon is ready 15 minutes before the first customer. The person closing ensures that the salon is cleaned, cashed up and locked. Responsibility is shown in the rota.

Opening

- Unlock, deactivate the alarm and switch on lights, music and sign.
- Check that the premises are clean and that the door and emergency exit are clear.
- Start the till and tablet, and check that the card terminal works.
- Count the float.
- Make coffee for customers.
- Review the day's bookings and staffing.
- Check stock of towels, capes, neck strips, razor blades, disinfectant, soap and hand cream.

Closing

- Clean and disinfect all tools (chapter 13). Used blades are placed in the sharps container.
- Clean floors, chairs, mirrors and counters. Used textiles go to the laundry.
- Cash up in the system and count the cash (chapter 7).
- Wash the coffee thermos and switch off electrical equipment that should not be left on.
- Check that everyone has clocked out.
- Switch off lights and music, activate the alarm and lock up.

6. Pay and remuneration

- Salary, commission and other remuneration follow from the employment contract.
- Salary is paid on the 10th of each month for the preceding month. If the 10th falls on a weekend or public holiday, payment is made on the next business day.
- Pay is based on registered working hours and sales registered to the Employee on the till. The payslip is published in the staff portal and shall be checked. Errors shall be reported to the general manager without delay.
- Holiday pay accrues at 10.2% and replaces salary in July.
- Barbers are placed in levels that determine the customer price. Promotion is assessed in the appraisal interview.
- Sales shall always be registered to the person who performed the service or sold the product.

7. Till and payment

All sales are registered on the till when the customer pays. Sales outside the till are not permitted.

- Services and products are registered to the correct employee and with the correct payment method. The customer shall be offered a receipt.
- Discounts are given only when set up in the system, or with the prior approval of the general manager.
- Cash is kept in the till. Change is taken only from the float.
- Cashing up is done every day at closing. Discrepancies shall be explained in the system. Material discrepancies are reported to the general manager the same day.
- Gift cards and punch cards are sold and redeemed only on the till. Gift cards cannot be redeemed for cash.
- Any correction of a sale shall always be explained.

Breach of the till routines is regarded as a material breach of the employment contract.

8. Holidays, absence and illness

Holidays

- Holidays are taken in accordance with the Annual Holidays Act, with 25 working days per year.
- Holiday requests are submitted in writing in the staff portal: winter, Easter and summer holidays by 31 January, autumn and Christmas holidays by 31 August.
- The Employer determines the timing after discussion with the Employee, taking into account that the salon must be adequately staffed. A holiday is granted only once it has been approved in the system.
- Holidays are normally not granted in December.

Illness

- Illness is reported to the general manager by telephone before the shift starts, no later than 08:00, stating the expected duration.
- Self-certification may be used after two months of employment, for up to three calendar days at a time and up to four times within a twelve-month period, cf. the National Insurance Act § 8-23.

- Absence beyond the self-certification period is documented by a doctor's sick note.
- In the event of longer sick leave, a follow-up plan is prepared together with the Employee, cf. the Working Environment Act § 4-6.

Other absence

- Doctor and dentist appointments are, as far as possible, scheduled outside working hours.
- Leave is requested in the staff portal as early as possible. A child's illness is reported in the same way as one's own illness.
- In the event of absence, the Employer may reassign the Employee's bookings to others, cf. clause 11 of the employment contract.

9. Customer service

- All customers shall be welcomed on arrival.
- Booked customers have priority. Walk-ins are taken only when this does not affect the next booking.
- In the event of delays, the waiting customer is informed of the expected waiting time.
- Customers who arrive up to 10 minutes late are served.
- Customers who are 15 minutes or more late without having given notice at least 5 minutes before the appointment are not served if this affects the next customer. The customer is instead offered a new appointment.
- Customers who do not show up are registered as «No-show» on the till.
- Complaints are handled calmly and objectively. The customer may be offered a free correction within 7 days. Refunds are given only by the general manager.
- Conversation with customers shall be professional. Politics, religion and talk about colleagues or other customers are avoided.
- Customers are served in Norwegian or English. Conversations with colleagues in a language the customer does not understand shall not take place while the customer is in the chair.

10. Dress, appearance and mobile phones

- The uniform is a white shirt and black bow tie, with dark trousers and clean shoes, or another uniform set by the general manager. The uniform shall be clean and ironed.
- Good personal hygiene is required. Strong perfume shall not be used.
- Mobile phones shall be on silent and out of sight while the Employee has a customer. Private use takes place during breaks.
- Music is played from the salon's sound system.

11. Smoking, snus and short breaks

- Smoking and the use of e-cigarettes are prohibited on the premises, cf. the Tobacco Control Act, and shall not take place at the entrance or the windows.
- Short breaks may only be taken when the Employee has no customer and there are at least 10 minutes until the next booking, and shall not exceed 10 minutes. A colleague shall be notified.
- Hands are washed with soap before resuming work. The customer shall not notice any smell of smoke.
- Snus and e-cigarettes shall not be used in view of customers.

12. Privacy, confidentiality and social media

- Information about customers and colleagues is subject to a duty of confidentiality, also after the employment has ended.

- Customer information in the system shall be used only for booking, till and customer follow-up, cf. the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR).
- Copying customer lists, taking pictures of screens with customer data or contacting customers from a private phone is not permitted.
- Logins and PINs are personal and shall not be shared. The Employee logs out of the till at the end of the shift.
- Photos and videos of customers require the customer's consent, with information on where the material will be used. Material for the salon's channels is sent to the person responsible for marketing.
- The Employee shall not speak negatively about the salon, colleagues or customers on social media.

13. Hygiene and infection control

The salon complies with the Regulations on hygiene requirements for hairdressing, skin care, tattooing and piercing businesses. The City of Oslo carries out inspections and may conduct unannounced visits.

For every customer

- Hands are washed or disinfected before treatment.
- A clean cape with a neck strip and a clean towel are used for every customer.
- A new razor blade is used for every customer. Used blades are placed in the sharps container.
- Combs, brushes, scissors, clippers and trimmers are cleaned and disinfected between customers.
- Hair is swept up after every customer.

Infection and cuts

- In the event of sores, rashes, lice or other signs of infection, the treatment is stopped. The customer is offered a new appointment, and the equipment used is disinfected.
- If a customer is cut, the bleeding is stopped with a clean compress. Gloves are used, waste is placed in the sharps container, and the incident is registered as a deviation (chapter 16).
- Towels and capes are washed at a minimum of 60 °C.

14. Health, safety and environment (HSE)

The Employer is responsible for a fully satisfactory working environment, cf. the Working Environment Act § 2-1. The Employee shall contribute by following the routines, using protective equipment and reporting hazards and deviations, cf. § 2-3.

Goals

- No work-related skin problems or injuries leading to absence.
- Sickness absence below 5%.
- HSE training for all new employees in their first working week.
- All deviations closed within 14 days.

Risk assessment

The risk assessment is reviewed with the employees at least once a year and in the event of changes in products, equipment or premises.

Risk	Measures
Hand eczema and allergy	Gloves for chemical treatments, fragrance-free hand cream, rings and bracelets removed.
Cuts and needlestick injuries	New blade per customer, sharps container and first aid equipment.
Strain injuries	Correct chair height, standing mat, varied working posture and breaks.
Infection between customers	Cleaning and disinfection in accordance with chapter 13.
Fire	Electrical equipment switched off at closing. Clear escape routes.
Violence, threats and robbery	Low cash holdings and routine in accordance with chapter 15.
High work pressure	Realistic booking and fixed break.

Skin and chemicals

- Gloves shall be used for colouring, bleaching and other chemical treatments.
- Safety data sheets for the salon's products are kept in the chemical register. New products shall be approved by the general manager before use.
- Skin problems shall be reported to the general manager at an early stage.

15. Fire, first aid, violence and threats

All employees shall know the location of the fire extinguisher, fire blanket, first aid equipment and escape routes from their first working day.

In the event of fire

1. Alert: shout «Fire!» and call 110.
2. Rescue: get customers and colleagues out through the nearest exit.
3. Extinguish: only if it is safe to do so.
4. Gather at the agreed assembly point. The person in charge on shift carries out a head count.

First aid

- If chemicals get into the eyes, rinse with clean water for at least 15 minutes and contact Poison Information.
- In the event of serious injury or acute illness, call 113.
- Use of first aid supplies is reported to the general manager.

Violence and threats

- Personal safety comes before property. The Employee shall keep a distance and avoid confrontation.
- The Employee may end the treatment and ask a customer to leave the salon if the customer is intoxicated, threatening or harassing.
- In the event of robbery, hand over what is demanded. Call the police on 112 when it is safe.
- The incident is registered as a deviation. The general manager ensures follow-up.

16. Deviations, whistleblowing and harassment

Deviations

Injuries, near misses, allergic reactions, defective equipment, material cash discrepancies and threats are reported to the general manager the same day, orally and in writing. The general manager follows up within 14 days.

Whistleblowing on censurable conditions

The Employee has the right to report censurable conditions, cf. chapter 2 A of the Working Environment Act. This includes, among other things, breaches of law, danger to life and health, harassment, discrimination and financial irregularities.

1. Reports are made to the general manager, the owner or the HSE contact. If the matter concerns the general manager, the report is made to the owner.
2. Reports may be made orally or in writing, and may be made anonymously.
3. Receipt is confirmed within 7 days. The matter is investigated without undue delay, and the whistleblower is informed of the outcome.
4. Retaliation against the whistleblower is prohibited. The information is treated confidentially.
5. Reports may always be made to the Norwegian Labour Inspection Authority or another public authority.

Harassment

The salon has zero tolerance for bullying, sexual harassment, racism and discrimination, including from customers. Such matters are reported to the general manager, the owner or the HSE contact and are treated as a whistleblowing report.

17. Alcohol and drugs

- Being under the influence of alcohol or other intoxicants during working hours is prohibited. Alcohol shall not be consumed in the salon during opening hours.
- Use of medication that may affect the ability to work (red triangle) shall be reported to the general manager. The Employee does not need to state the medication.
- Employees who appear to be under the influence are sent home, and the matter is followed up with a meeting.
- Employees with substance problems are encouraged to contact the general manager. Such enquiries are treated confidentially.

18. Training of new employees

New employees go through the following with the general manager or an experienced colleague during their first working week. Completed training is signed and filed.

First working day	First working week
Signed employment contract and registered personal details	Till, payment methods, gift cards and punch cards
Access to the staff portal and PIN for clocking in	Booking, moving appointments and «No-show»
Escape route, fire equipment, first aid and chemical register	Opening and closing routine and cashing up
Uniform issued	Hygiene, HSE, deviations and whistleblowing
Staff Handbook reviewed	Privacy, photos and social media

19. Changes

The Employer may amend the Handbook in the event of changes in law, routines or operations. Changes are discussed with the employees, published in the staff portal and apply from the date of announcement.

Date	Change
01.11.2026	First edition.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I confirm that I have read and understood the Staff Handbook of Downtown Barbers AS, and I undertake to comply with it. I am aware that the Handbook may be amended, and that changes are announced in the staff portal.

Name: _____

Position: _____

Date: _____

_____	_____
Employee	Downtown Barbers AS v/ Dawit Solomon Mengistu